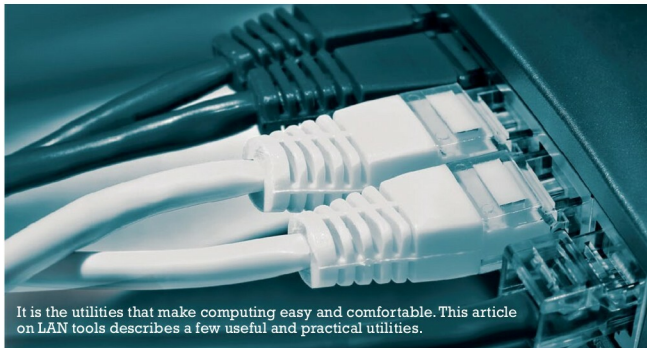


Computing Made Easy with LAN Tools



It is the utilities that make computing easy and comfortable. This article on LAN tools describes a few useful and practical utilities.

Various open source utilities are available to make the day-to-day tasks of LAN users and LAN administrators easy. This article tries to describe a few such interesting tools. The list is naturally a partial one, since the pool of utilities available is simply too large!

For more technical details of the tools mentioned in this article, please refer to documentation available on corresponding websites. Two of them - NMap and Wireshark - have been discussed extensively in earlier OSFY issues.

Use KeePass to remember all those passwords

One of the most cumbersome tasks for users as well as for administrators is remembering passwords. Along with improving security awareness levels, many organisations have enforced password policies such as the complexity norm (the password should have a minimum of one special character, and a combination of small and capital letters and digits). The policy could also mandate the minimum length (digit), age (password must be changed every 45 days) and history (you cannot repeat a password for predefined number of times) of the password to be selected.

Apart from various passwords that are used within the organisation, it is also necessary to remember personal passwords, as well as PIN numbers for personal email(s), credit/debit cards, social media platforms, mobile phone decryption, etc. Over and above this, it is recommended to use a different password for every application/website.

Since remembering so many passwords can get really challenging, try out KeePass, a tool that can be used to store all these safely.

As mentioned on the website, KeePass is a free, secure and open source password manager. You can put all your passwords in one database, which is locked with one master key or a key file. So you only have to remember one single master password or select the key file to unlock the whole database. The databases are encrypted using the best and most secure encryption algorithms currently known (AES and Twofish).

Download KeePass from <http://keepass.info/download.html>. The same page also gives links to contributed/unofficial KeePass packages available for various desktop and mobile operating systems, which include various Linux flavours, iPhone, iPad, Android, and a few more.

Antivirus software: Immundet and ClamAV

You can consider ClamAV as an antivirus engine that's available under GPL. As mentioned on clamav.net, it is used in a variety of situations including email scanning, Web scanning and end point security. It provides a number of utilities including a flexible and scalable multi-threaded daemon, a command line scanner and an advanced tool for automatic database updates.

Many email servers (for example, *qmail*) can use this to scan mails for possible virus-infected attachments.

For Windows users, there are two versions derived from ClamAV that are available.

Clamwin is available for free download from <http://www.clamwin.com/>. It is of course free, but there is one shortcoming - you need to scan each file manually, since there is no auto-scanning option.